



The forest floor

In temperate forests, plant life has to adapt to the four seasons. Flowers must shoot up early in the spring, before the trees start growing leaves blocking the sunlight. Then plants that have evolved to live in the shade take over, such as ferns and mosses, surviving on the little light that filters through.



Squill

Bell-shaped flowers carpet forest floors in western Europe in spring.



Wood anemone

These star-shaped flowers have a musky smell.



Hosta

Flower stems are held above the leaves to attract pollinators.



Calypso orchid

Cushions of moss can reach 4 in (10 cm) in height.



Broom forkmoss

The hairs attract insects for pollination, but this orchid does not produce nutritious nectar.

Lady's slipper orchid

The pouch-shaped petals force insects to brush past the yellow pollen above, aiding pollination.

These edible leaves have a garlicky smell and flavor.

Wild garlic

